

3.3 The Mac Mini

Apple fans have come to expect nothing but the best from Cupertino, California. However, not even the most ardent of Mac enthusiasts would have believed that a 6.5-inch long, 6.5-inch wide, and 2-inch tall computer could be made possible. Apple did make it possible on January 11, 2005. They released the Mac Mini on that day.

The Mac Mini is the cheapest Macintosh in the entire line of Apple computers, and is aimed at first-time Windows switchers, students, families, and anyone else looking for a low-cost computing solution. What's more is that the Mac Mini weighs just 1.5 kg, so you can actually carry it around!

The Mac Mini was initially released in two models based on the PPC architecture. The user had a choice of two processors: a 1.25 GHz G4 or a 1.42 GHz G4. The 1.25 GHz G5 model was priced at \$499, and the 1.42 GHz model was priced at \$599.

The next significant change made to the Mac Mini was the addition of a third model: a 1.42 GHz G4 Mac Mini with a DVD-Writer called “SuperDrive” in Mac parlance. This model came at a price of \$699. This update in July 2005 also brought about an increase in the RAM of all Mac Mini models. From July onwards, all Mac Mini models came with 512 MB RAM as standard.

On 28th February 2006, Mac Mini bid adieu to the PPC architecture. At a special event, Steve Jobs launched the new Mac Mini models with Intel processors. There were two models launched: One was a 1.5 GHz Intel Core Solo Mac Mini with a combo drive and the other was a 1.66 GHz Intel



The tiffin box Mac